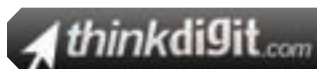


Linux to first support USB 3.0

The Linux 2.6.31 kernel, scheduled to release this August, will be the first operating system kernel to support USB 3.0. The first computers with the port are only going to be out by the end of the year though



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Flash Drive Test

Contact Sheet Memory Comparison Test

Brand	Company Name	Email Address	Phone Number	Web site
Verbatim	Verbatim Marketing India Pvt. Ltd.	ramesh.tuli@verbatim.co.in	91-11-46525661 / 62	www.verbatim.com
OCZ and Corsair	Tirupati Enterprises	mail@tirupati.net	91-33-22251192 / 93	www.tirupati.net
Transcend	Mediaman Infotech Pvt Ltd	sales@mediamangroup.com	91-22-43441122	www.mediagroup.com
SanDisk	SanDisk Corporation	manisha.sood@sandisk.com	91-124-4354243	www.sandisk.in
Kingston	Kingston Technology Company Inc.	vishal.parekh@kingston.com	1800-425-4515	www.kingston.com/india

from SanDisk. This turned out to be a completely one-sided affair. The SanDisk 8 GB card out-performed everything, but the SanDisk 16 GB card offers insane value for money. The 16 GB offers 96 per cent of the performance at 65 per cent of the cost per GB. There's just no beating that kind of value for money, and the trend of larger cards upstaging the rest because of a better cost per GB continues. The SanDisk 16 GB wins our Best Buy award in the MicroSD category.

Secure Digital

The SD category had more players, with one card each from Verbatim, Apacer, Kingston and SanDisk. As you can see from the score sheet, the SanDisk

Extreme III SD card just blew away the competition. However, that sort of performance comes at a premium, and although the Extreme III is our Best Performance award winner, most of you would not want to spend that kind of cash for an SD card.

The second best performer was the Apacer SD 2 GB card. This card also happens to be

SD

These are the true multi-purpose cards. Used in everything from phones, digital cameras, PMPs, camcorders, and various gadgets and gizmos, scoring this one was a little easier, with equal importance given to assorted and sequential reads and writes.

really cheap, and thus wins our Best Buy award. However, if you feel that a 2 GB card just will not meet your needs, the Kingston 4GB card is also a good buy. The Verbatim 1 GB card performs a lot better than the Kingston, but loses out terribly on its price per GB.

Memory Stick Pro Duo

Made specifically for Sony devices, these are rarer cards. We received two cards from SanDisk in this category: an older 8 GB and a new 16 GB version. The difference between old and new is obvious. Although the 8 GB is slightly cheaper per GB, it performs pathetically in comparison to the 16 GB. Anyone who has to buy an MS

MS PRO DUO

Memory Stick cards are used only in Sony devices. However, since Sony makes digital cameras, phones, and various gadgets like the PSP and PS2, this category is also scored like the SD category.

Pro card should only consider the 16 GB variant, because, let's face it, it's future proof and faster.

Conclusion

Remember, when you're buying memory for a device, try and gauge how that card is most likely to be used, and then make your own calculations based on the scores we provide you, so that you get the best value for your money.

Memory Type	SD			
Brand	Verbatim	Apacer	Kingston	SanDisk
Model	SD 1GB	SD 2GB	SDHC 4GB	Extreme III 8GB
Formatted Capacity (MB)	971		3,830	7,762
File Transfer Test (512 MB)				
Performance	Sequential Write Time (s)	70.7	102.8	119
	Sequential Write Speed (MBps)	7.24	4.98	4.3
	Sequential Read Time (s)	37.4	38.1	56.3
	Sequential Read Speed (MBps)	13.69	13.44	9.09
	Assorted Write Time (s)	248.1	175.1	246
	Assorted Write Speed (MBps)	2.06	2.92	2.08
	Assorted Read Time (s)	55.1	41.6	139
	Assorted Read Speed (MBps)	9.29	12.31	3.68
Price (Rs.)	400	499	779	4,499

Memory Type	Memory Stick Pro Duo	
Brand	SanDisk	SanDisk
Model	8GB Memory Stick Pro Duo	16GB Memory Stick Pro Duo
Formatted Capacity (MB)	7,618	15,248
File Transfer Test (512 MB)		
Performance	Sequential Write Time (s)	186.7
	Sequential Write Speed (MBps)	2.74
	Sequential Read Time (s)	83.3
	Sequential Read Speed (MBps)	6.15
	Assorted Write Time (s)	245
	Assorted Write Speed (MBps)	2.09
	Assorted Read Time (s)	116.5
	Assorted Read Speed (MBps)	4.39
Price (Rs.)	2,499	5,599